

ALL INDIA DISCOM ASSOCIATION (AIDA)
Minutes of 2nd Meeting of Committee on Capacity Building

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Welcome and Introduction

At the outset, Shri Satyendra Nath Kalita, Director (Regulatory Affairs) of AIDA welcomed the members of the AIDA Committee on Capacity Building. He opened the meeting highlighting AIDA's efforts in strengthening DISCOM capacity through knowledge sharing, training, and exposure visits. He mentioned four successful webinars on topics such as solarization of agricultural pumps, smart metering, consumer behavioral response, and human resource development. He further added two international exposure visits (to Manila and Bangkok) for senior DISCOM officials.

DG AIDA's Opening Remarks

Shri Alok Kumar, DG, AIDA highlighted AIDA's objective to identify emerging capacity-building needs of DISCOMs and work in collaboration with the Ministry of Power and NPTI to make them capable and future-ready. He informed about ongoing initiatives, including international and national exposure visits, leadership development programs, and the establishment of a Resource and Knowledge Centre as a Centre of excellence for knowledge sharing, innovation, and problem-solving in financial, technical, regulatory, and HR areas.

During the meeting, the following discussion were held and also inputs/suggestions given by respective Committee Members and officials of member Discoms:

DG NPTI's Remarks

Dr. Tripta Thakur, DG NPTI, highlighted that under the RDSS scheme, dedicated funding has been provided for training and capacity building in the distribution sector, with NPTI entrusted to implement the program. She informed that training under RDSS Phase I and II has been completed and Phase III is underway.

She further mentioned new initiatives, including the establishment of the National Data Analytics and Data Reporting (NADAR) Centre and the National SCADA Centre at NPTI, Faridabad, to train DISCOM engineers—targeting 10,000 junior engineers in data analytics. She emphasized the growing importance of data-driven decision-making and appreciated AIDA's collaboration and support in these initiatives.

Presentation by Rahul Pandey, Deputy Director, NPTI – Training Programs

Mr. Rahul Pandey presented an overview of NPTI's ongoing and planned training programs for DISCOM employees under various Government of India schemes, including RDSS and PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana. He informed that under RDSS, NPTI is conducting training in three phases covering all levels of DISCOM staff—from linemen to senior engineers—with an overall target of over 30,000 trainees.

He highlighted the establishment of two Centre of Excellence at NPTI, Faridabad — the National Data Analytics and Reporting (NADAR) Centre and the National SCADA Resource

Centre (NSRC). The NSRC will host simulators from six OEMs (expandable to ten) to provide hands-on training to DISCOM personnel on real SCADA systems, covering O&M practices, RTU/FRTU maintenance, and communication protocols. The NADAR Centre will focus on data analytics and reporting related to smart metering, enabling DISCOM officials to effectively use data from AMISPs for forecasting, load management, and operational efficiency. He also mentioned the newly approved Leadership and Strategic Management training program for SE level and above officers, being launched in collaboration with AIDA.

DG, AIDA, informed that the Leadership and Strategic Management program was conceptualized on the suggestion of the Secretary, Ministry of Power, to prepare future DISCOM leaders (SE and above) for higher managerial responsibilities. The program, designed jointly by AIDA and NPTI, has been approved by the Ministry of Power and will be launched shortly to strengthen leadership and strategic capabilities within DISCOMs.

He further highlighted that while AMI-related training was part of earlier RDSS phases, the NADAR Centre specifically focuses on practical use of data and analytics provided by AMISPs as per the smart meter contract provisions. He highlighted that the Ministry of Power has formed a committee, with AIDA's representation, to design training modules for all levels of DISCOM staff—from JEs to Chief Engineers—so that the workforce can fully leverage smart meter data for operational efficiency.

Presentation by Sanjay Agrawal, Professor, IGNOU – Certificate Programs

DG, AIDA, stated that AIDA, in collaboration with IGNOU, is working to introduce two online certification programs for DISCOM engineers to help them upgrade their technical and managerial skills while in service. The programs will have nominal fees, include contact classes and at the end of the course, they will earn a certificate for their profile.

Shri Sanjay Agrawal from IGNOU briefed about two programs identified in consultation with AIDA—Advanced Certificate in Power Distribution Management (ACPDM) and PG Diploma in Industrial Safety.

He explained that the ACPDM is a six-month program designed for professionals in the power sector, covering power distribution operations, energy management, safety, disaster management, and IT applications including smart metering and customer service.

The PG Diploma in Industrial Safety is a one-year program divided into two modules, with a provision for an interim PG Certificate in Industrial Safety after six months. The course covers safety principles, construction and electrical safety, occupational health, and industrial project management. Both programs are open to engineering and science graduates, offered online with contact classes, and are aimed at enhancing professional competence in the power and industrial sectors.

DG AIDA appreciated the quality of IGNOU's course material, noting that it comprehensively covers key technical and managerial aspects relevant to DISCOM operations. He suggested incorporating updated modules on smart metering and data analytics to align with current sectoral needs. He assured that AIDA would work closely with IGNOU to promote these programs and encourage Assistant Engineers and other DISCOM professionals to enroll for career

advancement and skill upgradation. He proposed forming a Sub-Committee to work with IGNOU to review and update the IGNOU ACPDM course content in line with evolving power distribution technologies, including smart metering, digital platforms, and operational efficiency. Representatives from AIDA, IGNOU, and DISCOMs agreed to be part of the committee.

Presentation by Jignesh T. Ray, GM (HR), GUVNL – Leadership Development Program

Shri Jignesh T. Ray presented GUVNL's Leadership Development Program aimed at creating a pipeline of future-ready leaders across its 65,000-strong workforce spanning generation, transmission, and distribution companies. The program is implemented through GUVNL's training wing, GETRI, and is structured as a five-level training framework: Level 1: Ignite leadership mindset, build foundation knowledge, self-awareness, emotional intelligence, and team dynamics (210 officers). Level 2: Operational excellence and innovation, with competency mapping and online learning support (105 officers). Level 3: Develop strategic thinking, cross-functional leadership, and sectoral insights for officers, including female employees. Level 4: Global exposure and benchmarking, representing GUVNL nationally and internationally, with training programs in Singapore, Germany, and Australia. Level 5: Transformational leadership, driving systematic change and policy impact.

The program also integrates emerging sectoral technologies, including energy storage, renewable energy, green hydrogen, and digital twinning. GUVNL is collaborating with IITs and the Gujarat Employment & Training Department to develop skill-building and upskilling courses for employees at all levels, ensuring a sustainable, future-ready workforce.

DG, AIDA, appreciated the GUVNL Leadership Development Program and proposed that AIDA organize a visit for officials from member DISCOMs to the Gujarat Energy Training & Research Institute (GETRI). This visit aims to provide first-hand exposure to best practices in capacity building, supporting AIDA's objective of strengthening workforce capabilities across DISCOMs.



(Satyendra Nath Kalita)

Convenor, AIDA Committee